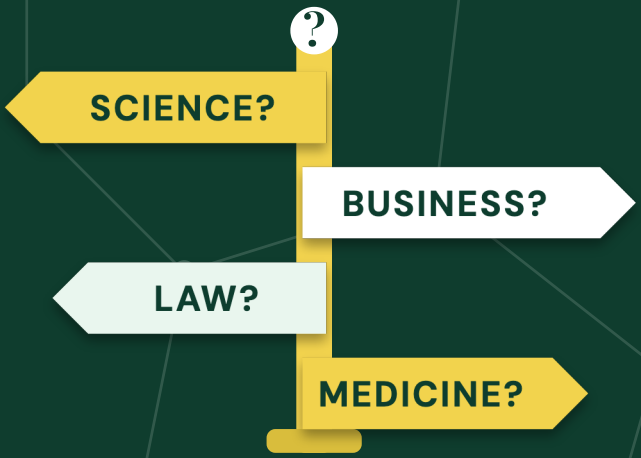
A MENTOR'S WORKBOOK · FILL IN AS YOU GO

Not sure *what to study?*

কী পড়ব? — এর একটাই সঠিক উত্তর নেই। আছে সঠিকভাবে ভাবার একটা পথ।

For students from SSC to HSC and beyond: how to choose a field without betting everything on one seat.



Fill-in pages · Plans A, B, C · Made for Bangladesh

A field is a door, not a destiny.

A WORKBOOK BY ONNOY · অন্বয়

Not Sure What to Study?

A mentor's workbook for choosing a field of study

কী পড়ব? — সঠিকভাবে ভাবার একটা পথ

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PUBLISHED BY	Onnoy · অন্বয় — a youth-led decision-making mentorship initiative for students, parents and teachers.
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COPYING	© Onnoy 2026. Licensed under Creative Commons BY-NC-SA 4.0: you may photocopy, share and adapt this workbook for non-commercial use if you credit Onnoy and share it under the same terms.

A NOTE ON FACTS	Admission rules, seats, fees and dates change every year and differ by institution. Nothing here replaces the official circular. Use this workbook to decide how to think, then confirm every number on the official site.
FIND US	Onnoy on Facebook. Scan the code on the back cover, or search for "Onnoy".

How to use this workbook.

This workbook won't tell you which subject to choose. It shows you how to decide well, so that whatever the result, you'll be okay. The blank boxes are yours to write in — use a pen, not a phone.

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First, the voices in your head.

লোকে কী বলবে?
What will people say?

ভুল সাবজেক্ট নিলে সব শেষ!
If I pick wrong, everything is ruined.

চান্স না পেলে কী হবে?
What if I don't get a seat?

খরচ চালাতে পারব তো?
Can we afford this?

সবাই তো একই দিকে যাচ্ছে...
Everyone else seems to be going the same way.

Almost every student in Bangladesh hears these voices.

✎ THE VOICE I HEAR MOST OFTEN

THINK LIKE THIS →

Being confused means you take your future seriously. Stay with the question.

You can't control the result. You can control how you decide.

Not in your hands

- Number of seats
- Cut-off marks
- Result day
- What people say

In your hands

- The facts you collect
- The people you ask
- The plans you make
- How you respond

ONE THING FROM "IN YOUR HANDS" I'LL ACT ON THIS WEEK

THINK LIKE THIS →

Good information and a backup plan make a good decision — even if the result still surprises you.

A field is a door, not a destiny.

A few careers need one exact degree — doctor, engineer, lawyer. Most don't. One degree can lead to many roads:

- Government service
- NGO & development
- Teaching & research
- Banking & business
- Media & writing
- Your own venture

⚠ Many government posts, including BCS general cadres, are open to graduates of many subjects — not just one. Always read the actual circular before assuming a door is closed.

ONE DOOR I WANT TO KEEP OPEN, WHATEVER I CHOOSE

Why it matters to me:

THINK LIKE THIS →

Don't ask “Which subject is best?” Ask “Which one keeps the most good doors open for someone like me?”

Three honest questions.

1 **What do I enjoy?**
What do you read, watch or try without anyone telling you to?

2 **What am I good at?**
Your marks, yes. Also what friends ask your help with.

3 **What work suits me?**
Working with people, numbers, ideas, or your hands?

Watch out: a senior's or cousin's choice fits *them* — but it might not automatically fit you too.

YOUR THREE ANSWERS — YOU'LL NEED THEM AGAIN ON PAGE 9

1 · I enjoy _____

2 · I'm good at _____

3 · I work best with _____

THINK LIKE THIS →

Choose what fits you, not what fits the trend.

Now, the real-world limits.

Money

Add up the whole degree: fees, books, food, travel or hostel. Ask for the total in writing.

Place

Near home or away? Travel, rent and safety change the cost and the comfort.

Time

How long will it really take? Ask seniors about session delays.

Family

Does anyone depend on you earning soon? Be honest about it.

THE LIMIT I NEED TO PLAN AROUND MOST, RIGHT NOW

THINK LIKE THIS →

Limits don't shrink your future. They shape your route. Plan inside them, then stretch them step by step.

What are the fields, really? 1 of 2

Engineering & Technology

Civil, Electrical, Mechanical, CSE, Textile & more

Designing, building and fixing the systems around us. **Might fit you if:** you enjoy maths, physics, and how-things-work problems.

Medical & Health Sciences

MBBS, BDS, Nursing, Pharmacy, Public Health

Long, demanding study that leads to caring for people directly. **Might fit you if:** biology draws you in, and you have patience for a long road.

Pure & Applied Sciences

Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics, Statistics, Environment

Understanding why things happen, often through research. **Might fit you if:** you ask "why" more often than "what."

Information Technology

Computer Science, Software Engineering, IT

Building the apps, sites and systems we all use daily. **Might fit you if:** you like logic, puzzles, building step by step.

Agriculture & Environment

Agriculture, Fisheries, Forestry, Food Science

Working with land, food and nature — vital for Bangladesh. **Might fit you if:** you care about farming, food, or climate.

TWO THAT SOUND LIKE ME SO FAR

What are the fields, really? 2 of 2

Business & Finance
BBA, Accounting, Economics, Finance

Organising money, people and ideas to build something. **Might fit you if:** you like numbers, planning, or leading a team.

Social Sciences & Development
Social Development, Sociology, Political Science, Public Admin

Understanding society, and working to improve it. **Might fit you if:** you want to work directly with people and communities.

Law
LLB and related study

Reading closely, arguing fairly, understanding rules. **Might fit you if:** you enjoy debate and have an eye for fairness.

Arts, Media & Communication
Journalism, Mass Comm, Fine Arts, Film, Music

Telling stories and creating things people feel. **Might fit you if:** you enjoy writing, designing, or performing.

Education
Teaching-focused degrees and training

Teaching and explaining, shaping how others learn. **Might fit you if:** you're patient, and enjoy helping people understand.

THINK LIKE THIS →

Not a complete list, but a start. Circle two or three that sound like you, then compare with page 7.

Your group, your doors.

Your HSC group — Science, Commerce or Humanities — affects what you can apply for. But rules differ by university, and some doors stay open across groups.

Science group

USUALLY	Engineering, Medical, Pure Science, IT/CSE, Agriculture
OFTEN TOO	Business, Social Science, some Arts programmes

Commerce group

USUALLY	Business & Finance — BBA, Accounting, Economics
OFTEN TOO	Social Science, some Arts, some general programmes
RARELY	Engineering, Medical

Humanities / Arts group

USUALLY	Law, Social Science, Arts & Media, Education
OFTEN TOO	Some Business and general programmes
RARELY	Engineering, Medical

⚠ Public admission isn't one test: general universities share a cluster test; engineering and agriculture run their own; medical has its own exam. Always confirm on the official website.

THINK LIKE THIS →

Your group is a strong start, not a locked gate. Before crossing over, check the exact eligibility rule.

Four roads. None is "the best."

Public university

- Low fees
- Strong, respected names
- Very competitive — apply to more than one

Private university

- More seats available
- Higher fees
- Check UGC approval & scholarships

National University

- Colleges in many towns
- Low fees
- Quality varies — check teachers & delays

Study abroad

- Big doors, big costs
- Needs English tests & a money plan
- Be careful with agents

Other real doors: polytechnic diploma · nursing & health technology · open university · skills training

THE ROAD THAT FITS MY LIMITS BEST, AND WHY

THINK LIKE THIS →

Ask which road fits you, and what it needs from you.

Who is giving you this advice?

- Official website, UGC, govt. circular — STRONGEST
- Seniors and relatives (one person's story)
- YouTube guru or Facebook group
- Coaching-centre advertisement
- Viral post or screenshot — WEAKEST

⚠ RED FLAGS

- "Guaranteed seat!"
- Money to a personal bKash or Nagad number
- "Last chance" admission link on Messenger

✎ THE LAST BIG ADMISSION CLAIM I SAW — WHERE DID IT ACTUALLY COME FROM?

THINK LIKE THIS →

Advice is only as good as its source. Confirm important facts on official sites.

AI can help you think. It can't decide for you.

✓ Good uses

- Brainstorm careers you haven't heard of
- Explain a subject simply
- Draft questions for a senior

⚠ Be careful

- Fees, cut-offs and dates can sound sure and be wrong or old
- It doesn't know your family or the latest circular
- Never share ID, phone or bKash details

CHECK ANYTHING IMPORTANT WITH SIFT

S	I	F	T
Stop	Investigate the source	Find better coverage	Trace to the original

ONE THING I'LL ASK AI TO HELP ME WITH THIS WEEK

THINK LIKE THIS →

AI widens your ideas. Official sources confirm your facts. You make the decision.

Ask better questions.

Swap the vague question for one that gets a real answer:

✗ VAGUE ~~Is this subject good?~~
✓ ASK **What does a normal week look like for you?**

✗ VAGUE ~~Will I get a job?~~
✓ ASK **What helped you get started, besides the degree?**

✗ VAGUE ~~Which one is better?~~
✓ ASK **What do you wish you'd known before choosing?**

Ask: a teacher who knows you, a senior, someone working in that job, the admission office.

Talking to parents? Their worry usually means "we want you safe." Show them Plans A, B, C and total costs, not just your dream.

SOMEONE I'LL ASK THIS WEEK, AND WHAT I'LL ASK THEM

THINK LIKE THIS →

Good questions get you real stories, not just opinions.

Try a small taste first.

1	Read the syllabus. It shows what you'll really study.	30 min
2	Visit the campus or college. Sit in a class if you can.	1 day
3	Talk to one senior and one person working in that field.	2 chats
4	Try it: a free online lesson, a small project, or volunteering.	1 week
5	Notice your energy. Did time fly, or did it drag?	Always

THE TEST I'LL TRY FIRST, AND WHEN

THINK LIKE THIS →

Small tests are cheap. A wrong four-year choice is expensive.

Don't bet everything on one seat.

A — Your first choice
The goal that excites you and still makes sense.

B — A good option
One you'd be happy with if A doesn't happen.

C — A safe option
Keeps you moving and learning while you try again.

Set a switch date. "If Plan A isn't confirmed by _____ I move to Plan B." Apply to more than one road — deadlines differ.

WRITE YOUR PLANS

A _____

B _____

C _____

THINK LIKE THIS →

Having a backup plan doesn't mean you doubt yourself. It means you're being smart.

Put your options side by side.

Write up to three options in the dashed boxes. Then tick each cell and add up the score.

✓ yes = 2 ? not sure = 1 ✕ no = 0

	OPTION	OPTION	OPTION
Leads toward my goal			
I'd stay interested			
Affordable in total			
Keeps doors open			
I can live with the worst case			
Score			

⚠ Numbers don't decide for you. If the top score disappoints you, pay attention to that — your feelings are information too, not just the score.

Whatever the result, you'll be okay.

You got Plan A

Well done. The degree is a start. Build skills, join clubs, look for internships.

You got Plan B or C

It's a road, not a verdict. Add skills every path rewards: communication, digital skills, teamwork.

It didn't go as hoped

Take a day to feel it. Then list what's still open: another round, private or NU, a diploma, a skills course.

ONE THING THAT STAYS TRUE ABOUT ME, WHATEVER THE RESULT

THINK LIKE THIS →

একটা ফলাফল তোমার মূল্য ঠিক করে না।

If it feels too heavy, talk to a teacher, a family member or a counsellor you trust.

Your next seven days.

DAYS 1–2	Write your answers to the questions on pages 7 and 8.
DAYS 3–4	Pick two fields from pages 9–10. Research them on official sites.
DAYS 5–6	Read one syllabus. Talk to one senior and one working person.
DAY 7	Fill in Plans A, B and C. Show someone you trust.

BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS WORKBOOK

I'm starting on (date): _____

My biggest takeaway: _____

Your future isn't decided by one exam day. It's built by many small, careful choices.

ফলাফল যা-ই হোক, সঠিকভাবে ভাবতে শিখলে তুমি ঠিক এগিয়ে যাবে।

Words you'll hear.

SSC / HSC
Secondary & Higher Secondary Certificate exams, end of Class 10 and Class 12.

Group
Your subject stream: Science, Commerce, or Humanities/Arts.

GPA
Grade Point Average — your result on a 0–5 scale.

Cut-off mark
The lowest score that got someone in last time. It moves every year.

Merit list
The ranked list of who gets a seat, by score.

Waiting list
Not admitted yet, but next in line if a seat opens.

Migration
Moving to a preferred subject or university after admission, if a seat opens.

Viva
A short spoken interview, sometimes part of admission.

Quota
Reserved seats for specific groups, set by policy.

Affiliated college
Teaches a university's syllabus (often under National University) but isn't the university itself.

Circular
The official notice with rules, dates and requirements for a specific admission.

Cluster test
One shared admission exam used by a group of universities.

Where to check facts — don't memorise them

The university's own website	**UGC — ugc.gov.bd** — approved universities
Your admission cluster's own site	**BPSC — bpsc.gov.bd** — govt. job circulars

Things I want to remember.

Names of people to ask, dates of circulars, questions for the next session.

About Onnoy.

Onnoy (অন্বয়: "connection") is a youth-led mentorship initiative in Mymensingh, Bangladesh. We help students, and the parents and teachers who guide them, make better decisions: what to study, what to believe online, and how to use new tools without giving themselves away.

Onnoy began in 2026 in the Changemakers' Programme of Amra Notun Network and BRAC Youth Platform. The cohort ended; the work did not. Students who finish our sessions go on to mentor others, and everything we publish is drafted, checked and tested by the team before it reaches a classroom.

Sessions

Hands-on workshops in schools and colleges. Students do; we don't lecture.

Booklets

Short, printable guides like this one. Free to copy for non-commercial use.

Peer mentors

Students who finish a session help the next group, so the habit outlives the visit.

For parents & teachers

Plain-language material for the adults students turn to first.

WANT A SESSION AT YOUR SCHOOL, COLLEGE OR CLUB?

Message us on Facebook. Scan the code on the back cover, or search for Onnoy.

Your future isn't decided by one exam day.

- Know **yourself** before you compare the fields.
- Check the **source** before you trust the claim.
- Make **Plans A, B and C**. Then make the call yourself.

Onnoy

Connecting Necessary Dots

অন্বয়

SCAN TO FIND ONNOY ON FACEBOOK

ALSO FROM ONNOY

Make Free AI Work for You · a 10-step guide

অনিমা (Onima) · a picture story about attention

Admission rules, fees and cluster tests change every year. Treat every number in this workbook as a prompt to check on the official circular, not a fact to memorise. This edition was checked in September 2026.

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